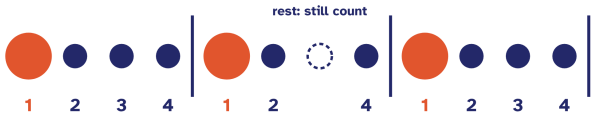
TIME · PULSE AND THE BAR · LEARN

Pulse and the bar



REMEMBER Beats are grouped into bars; beat 1 of every bar is the strongest.

1 Strong beats ★☆☆

Each dot is one beat. Circle the strong beat in every bar. In 4/4, also underline the medium beat.

2/4



3/4



4/4



2 Name the signs ★☆☆

Write the name of each sign and what it tells you.

SIGN	NAME	IT TELLS YOU
		
		
		

3 Count it ★★☆

Write a count in every box: the beat you play, then the beats you hold. The first bar is done.



4 Slow to fast ★☆☆

Number the marks from the slowest (1) to the fastest (4). The first is done.

♩ = 120	♩ = 60	♩ = 92	♩ = 76
4			

5 How fast does it feel? ★☆☆

About **60** is slow (a clock's tick); about **120** is fast. Try a metronome and write the number that feels like each.

a slow walk ♩ = ☐

marching ♩ = ☐

running ♩ = ☐

Date _____

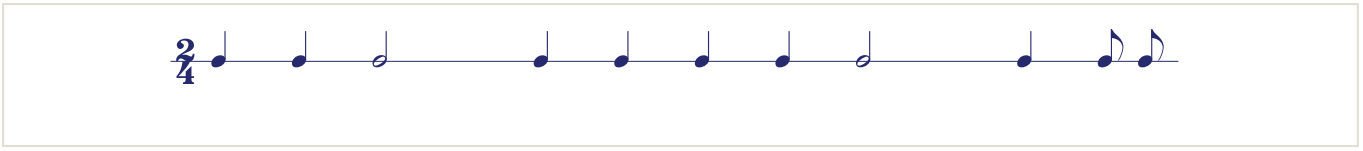
TIME · PULSE AND THE BAR · USE

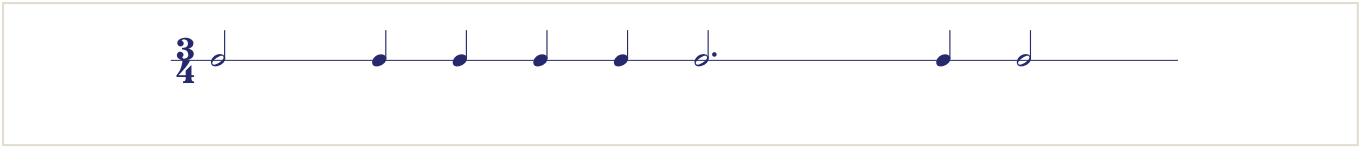
Pulse and the bar

REMEMBER A long note still has every one of its beats counted.

1 Add the bar lines ★★☆

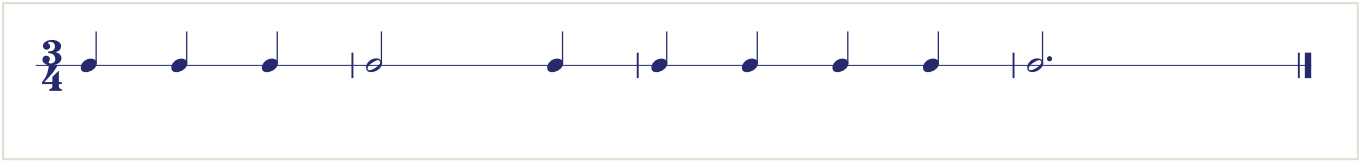
Draw a bar line after every full bar and a final bar line at the end.





2 Spot the mistake ★★☆

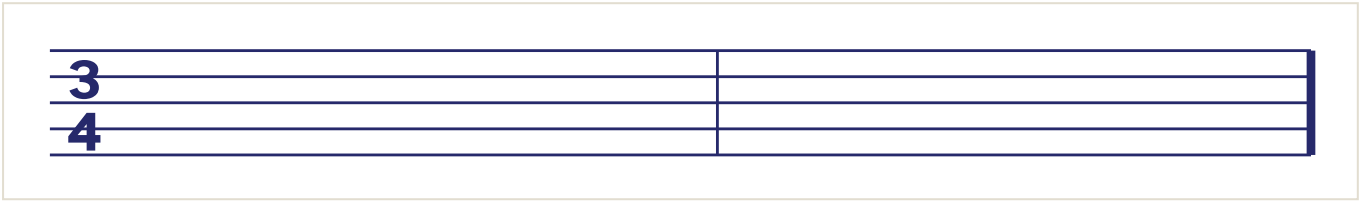
One bar has the wrong number of beats. Circle it and write how many beats it has.



beats in the wrong bar ☐

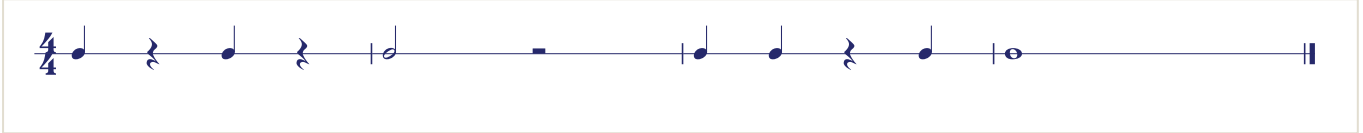
3 Make your own ★★★

Write two bars of 3/4 using crotchets and minims. Clap them while counting, then play them on one note.



4 Clap and count ★☆☆

Set a metronome to ♩ = 60. Clap on the notes, open your hands on the rests, count aloud. Tick a circle each time it is steady.
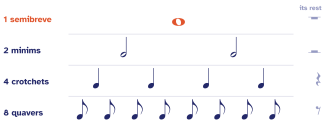


○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____

TIME · NOTES AND RESTS · LEARN

Notes and rests



REMEMBER Each plain note lasts half as long as the one above it; every note has a rest of the same length.

1 Name, beats and rest ★☆☆

Write each note's name and beats (crotchet = 1 beat), then draw the rest of the same length. The first row is done.

NOTE	NAME	BEATS	REST
𝅝	**semibreve**	**4**	𝄻
𝅗𝅥	_____	☐	☐
𝅗𝅥	_____	☐	☐
♪	_____	☐	☐
𝅗𝅥.	_____	☐	☐
♪	_____	☐	☐

2 Draw it ★★☆

Draw one note for each length (crotchet = 1 beat).

2 beats	½ beat	3 beats	4 beats
☐	☐	☐	☐

3 Why a whole note? ★☆☆

One pizza = one beat. The note that fills all four pizzas of a 4/4 bar is the **whole note**; shorter notes cut one pizza into pieces. Colour each share, write the other name and the beats.

𝅝 **semibreve**	**whole note**	**4 beats**	
𝅗𝅥 **minim**	_____	_____	beats
♩ **crotchet**	_____	_____	beats
♪ **quaver**	_____	_____	beats
𝅘𝅥𝅯 **semiquaver**	_____	_____	beats

Date _____

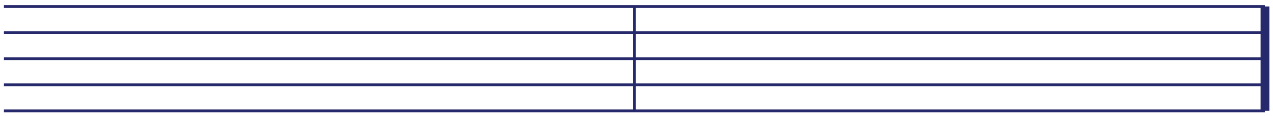
TIME · NOTES AND RESTS · USE

Notes and rests

REMEMBER Below the middle line, stems go up on the right; above it, down on the left.

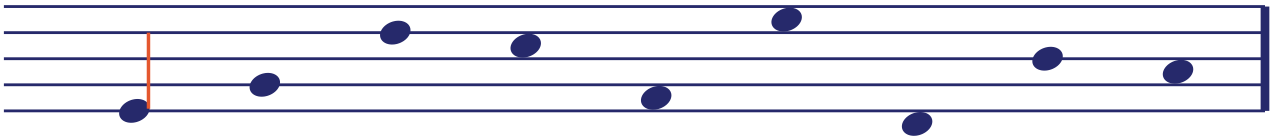
1 Rests on the staff ★☆☆

Draw a semibreve rest in the first bar (it hangs below the fourth line) and a minim rest in the second (it sits on the middle line).



2 Draw the stems ★★☆

Turn every head into a crotchet: add a stem going the right way. The first is done.



3 Finish with a rest ★★☆

Each bar is short. Complete it with one rest. The first is done.



rest **minim rest** rest _____ rest _____ rest _____

4 Rests are empty slices ★☆☆

A rest is silence that lasts as long as its note. Shade each rest's share of the pizzas with lines, then write its beats. The first is done.



semibreve rest		**4 beats**
minim rest		_____ beats
crotchet rest		_____ beats
quaver rest		_____ beats

Date _____

TIME · HOW LONG IS A NOTE? · LEARN
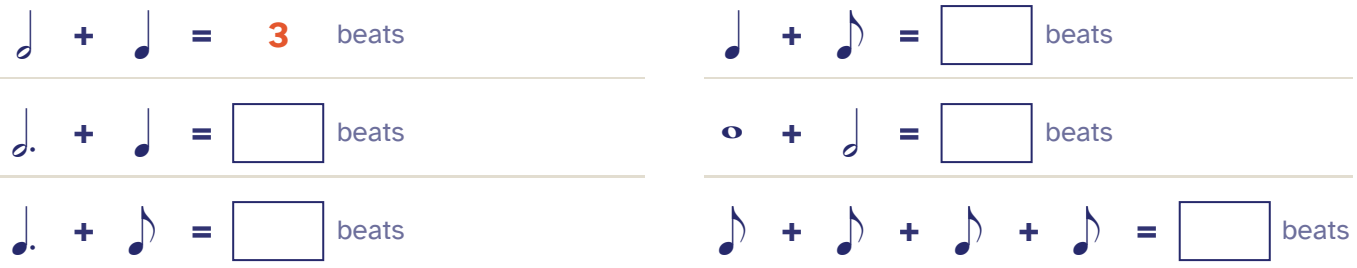
How long is a note?



REMEMBER A dot adds half the note's value; a tie joins two notes of the same pitch into one sound.

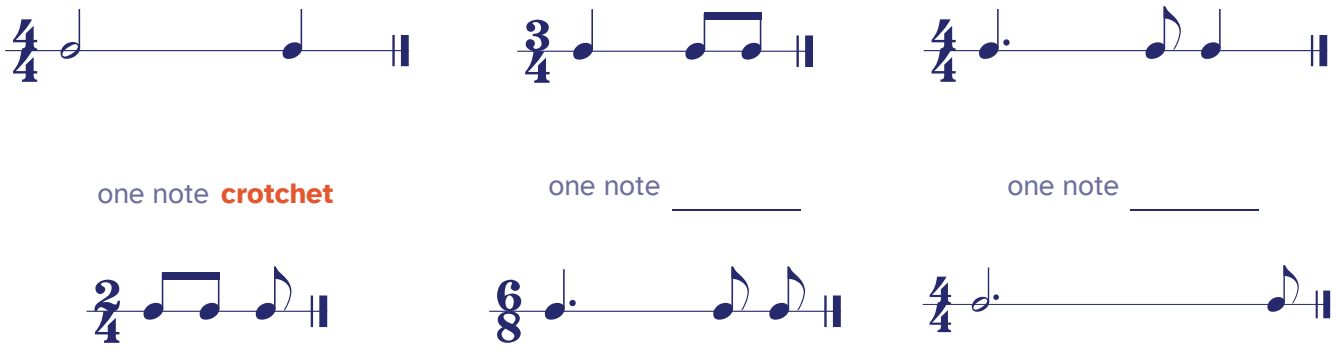
1 Note sums ★☆☆

Add up the beats (crotchet = 1 beat). The first one is done.



2 Complete the bar ★★☆

Each bar is one note short. Count the beats you have, then find what is missing. The first is done: 4/4 needs 4 beats; minim 2 + crotchet 1 = 3, so **1 beat** is missing: a crotchet.

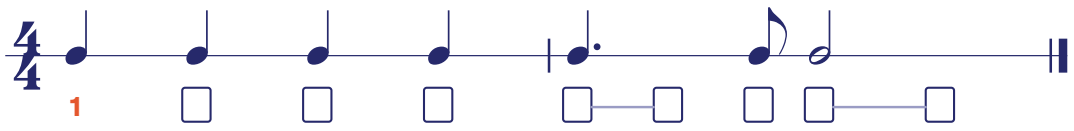


one note **crotchet** | one note _____ | one note _____

one note _____ | one note _____ | one note _____

3 Ode to Joy: count it ★★☆

Bars 3–4 of Beethoven's Ode to Joy (Handbook p. 40). Write a count in every box, then sing it as you clap. The first is done.



Date _____

TIME · HOW LONG IS A NOTE? · USE

How long is a note?

REMEMBER A tie can cross a bar line; a dot cannot.

1 Tie or dot?

★★☆

Each tie makes one sound. Write the one dotted note that lasts the same. The first is done.



dotted note **dotted minim**



dotted note _____



dotted note _____

2 Spot the mistake

★★☆

One bar does not add up to four beats. Circle it and write how many beats it has.



beats in the wrong bar ☐

3 Clap and count

★☆☆

Clap the dotted rhythms, counting the "&" inside each dotted crotchet. Tick a circle each time it is steady.



○ ○ ○ ○ ○

4 In your music

★☆☆

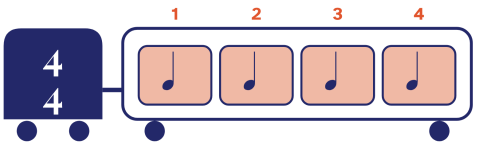
Find each of these in a piece you are learning.

FIND IN A PIECE YOU ARE LEARNING	PIECE	BAR
a dotted minim		
a dotted crotchet		
a tie		
a rest of one whole bar		

Date _____

TIME · TIME SIGNATURES · LEARN

Time signatures



REMEMBER Top number: how many counts in a bar. Bottom number: which note is one count.

1 Which time signature?

★☆☆

Each line is one full bar. Write a time signature that fits. The first is done.



time signature **3/4**



time signature _____



time signature _____



time signature _____



time signature _____



time signature _____

2 Simple or compound?

★★☆

Circle simple or compound, then write how many beats are in each bar. The first is done.

$\frac{3}{4}$	**simple** · compound	beats **3**	$\frac{6}{8}$	simple · compound	beats
$\frac{2}{2}$	simple · compound	beats	$\frac{9}{8}$	simple · compound	beats
$\frac{4}{4}$	simple · compound	beats	$\frac{12}{8}$	simple · compound	beats
$\frac{3}{8}$	simple · compound	beats	$\frac{6}{4}$	simple · compound	beats

3 What does it mean?

★☆☆

Complete each sentence.

In 3/4 there are ____ beats in a bar, and each beat is a _____ .

In 6/8 there are ____ beats in a bar, and each beat is a _____ .

C means the same as ____ ; ¢ means the same as ____ .

Date _____

TIME · TIME SIGNATURES · USE

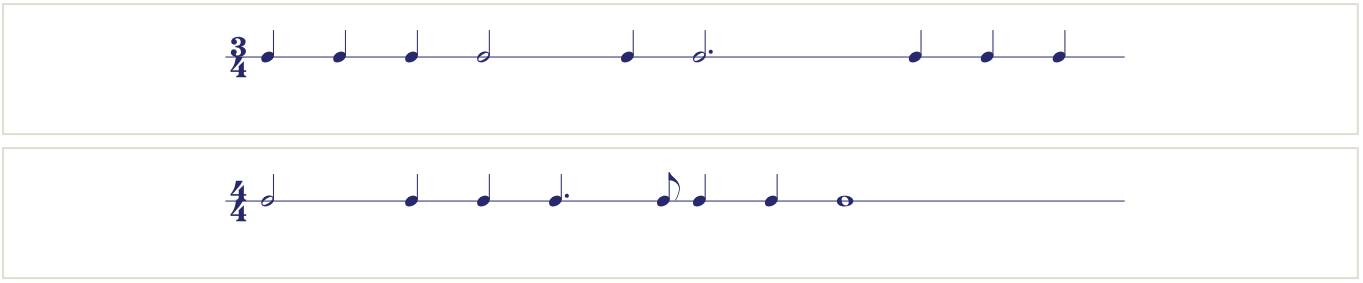
Time signatures

REMEMBER In compound time each beat is a dotted note, divided into three.

1 Add the bar lines

★★☆

Draw a bar line after every full bar, and a final bar line at the end.



2 Beam them

★★★

The same six quavers in two time signatures. Join them with beams to show the beats: in twos for 3/4, in threes for 6/8.



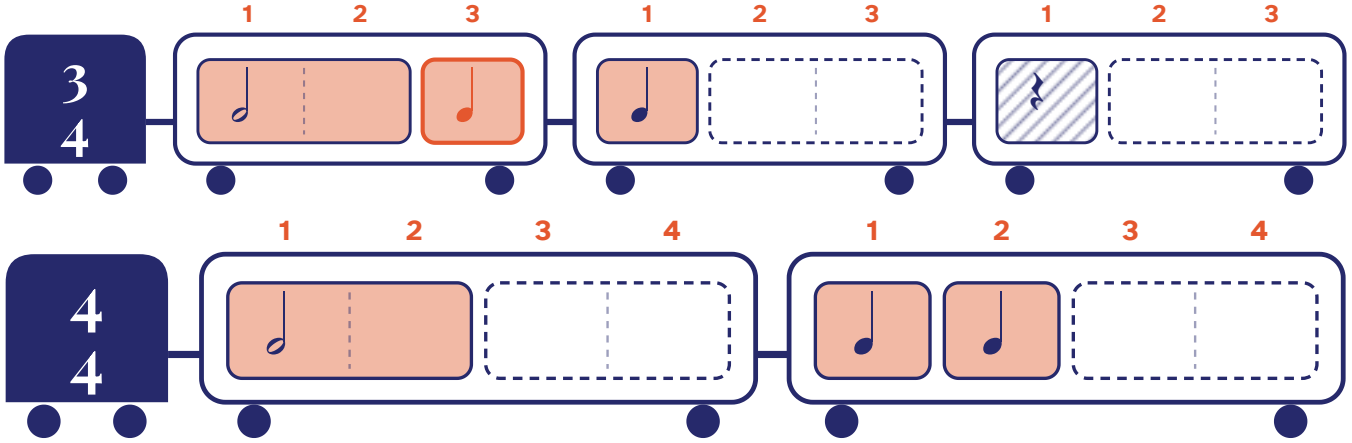
3 beats

2 beats

3 Book every seat

★★☆

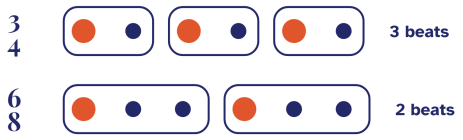
Each carriage is one bar of the time signature on the engine. Draw one note or rest in the dashed seats so every seat is booked. The first is done.



Date _____

TIME · COMPOUND AND IRREGULAR TIME · LEARN

Compound and irregular time

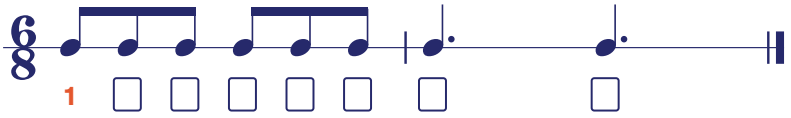


REMEMBER In 6/8 each beat is a dotted crotchet, split into three: count 1 2 3 4 5 6, feel two.

1 Count 6/8

★☆☆

Write a count in every box. The first is done.



2 3/4 or 6/8?

★★☆

Both bars hold six quavers. Look at the beams and write the time signature. The first is done.



time signature **3/4**

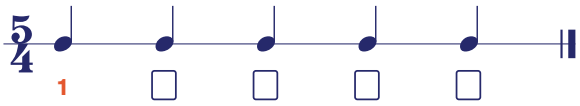


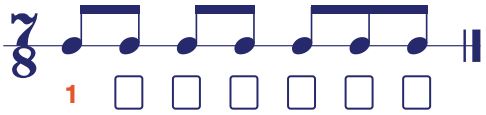
time signature _____

3 Uneven bars

★★☆

Count 5/4 as 3 + 2 and 7/8 as 2 + 2 + 3: write the count in every box. The first of each is done.





4 Beats in compound time

★☆☆

Complete each line: how many dotted-crotchet beats in a bar? The first is done.

6/8	**2**	beats
9/8		beats
12/8		beats

5 Feel two

★☆☆

Clap six quavers counting 1 2 3 4 5 6, then clap again saying only “1” and “4”. Tick a circle each time the two beats feel steady.

Date _____

TIME · COMPOUND AND IRREGULAR TIME · USE

Compound and irregular time

REMEMBER Many dances keep 4/4 but group its eight quavers 3 + 3 + 2.

1 Add the bar lines ★★☆

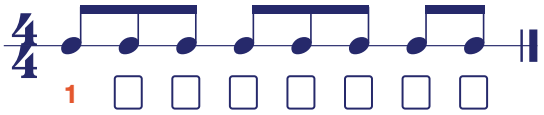
Draw a bar line after every full bar and a final bar line at the end.





2 3 + 3 + 2 ★★☆

Write the count in every box (1 2 3 1 2 3 1 2), then tap it, louder on each 1. Tick a circle each time it is steady.



○ ○ ○ ○ ○

3 Clap and count ★★☆

Clap with a metronome, counting six quavers, feeling two beats. Tick a circle each day it is steady.



○ ○ ○ ○ ○

4 In your music ★☆☆
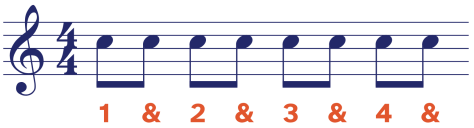
Find each of these in a piece you are learning or listening to.

FIND IN A PIECE YOU ARE LEARNING	PIECE	BAR
a piece in 6/8		☐
a bar of quavers beamed in threes		☐
a piece in 5/4 or 7/8 (listen: Take Five)		☐

Date _____

TIME · GROUPS AND UPBEATS · LEARN

Groups and upbeats



REMEMBER Beams show the beats: they join the notes of one beat, or in 4/4 of beats 1–2 or 3–4, never across the middle.

1 Good grouping?

★★☆

Circle ✓ if the grouping shows the beats, × if it hides one. The first is done.



✓ ×



✓ ×



✓ ×



✓ ×

2 Cut the beat

★☆☆

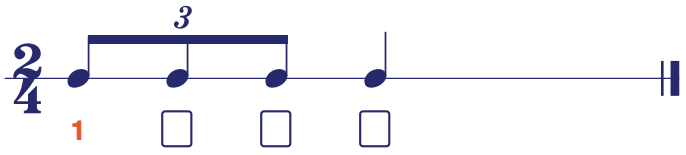
One beat is one pizza. Colour each one, then write how much of a beat each note gets and how you count it. The first is done.

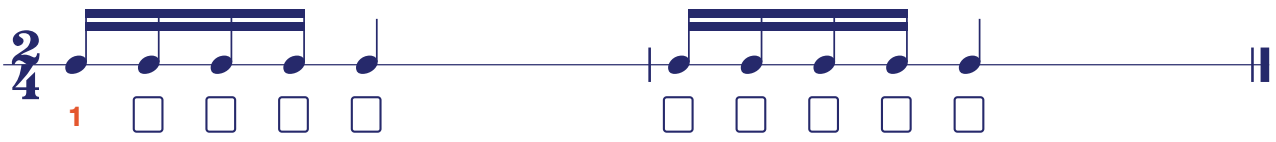
two quavers		half a beat each	1 &
a triplet		_____	_____
four semiquavers		_____	_____

3 Count it

★★☆

Write a count in every box: a triplet (1 & a), then semiquavers (1 e & a). The first of each is done.





Date _____

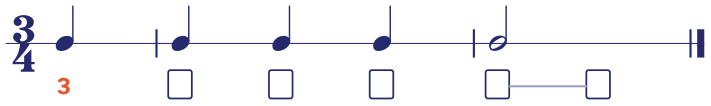
TIME · GROUPS AND UPBEATS · USE

Groups and upbeats

REMEMBER An upbeat and the last bar together make one full bar.

1 The upbeat ★★☆

This piece starts on beat 3 (done for you). Write a count in every other box. Then: how many beats does the last bar need?



beats in the last bar ☐

2 Clap the upbeat ★☆☆

Clap the piece in exercise 1 with a metronome: count “1 2” silently, clap on 3. Tick a circle each time the last bar is exactly two beats.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

3 Clap and count ★★☆

Triplets and semiquavers: clap with a metronome while counting aloud. Tick a circle each day it is steady.



○ ○ ○ ○ ○

4 In your music ★☆☆

Find each of these in a piece you are learning.

FIND IN A PIECE YOU ARE LEARNING	PIECE	BAR
an upbeat (anacrusis)		
a triplet		
four semiquavers in one beat		

Date _____

TIME · OFF THE BEAT · LEARN

Off the beat



REMEMBER Syncopation: a note that starts between the beats and is held across the next one.

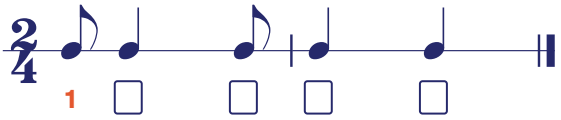
1 Find the off-beat notes ★★☆

Tap the beat. Circle every note that starts on an "&", between the beats.



2 Count a syncopation ★★☆

Write a count in every box. Keep the beat in your foot. The first is done.



3 Swing ★☆☆

Which line shows how swung quavers are played? Circle A or B, then play both and hear the difference.

A



B



4 Foot and hands ★☆☆

Tap the beat with your foot and clap only on the "&"s. Then swap: clap the beats, tap the "&"s. Tick a circle each time it holds together.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

5 True or false? ★☆☆

Circle T or F.

A syncopated note starts between the beats.	T	F
Swing quavers are written long–short.	T	F
In syncopation the beat stops for a moment.	T	F

Date _____

TIME · OFF THE BEAT · USE

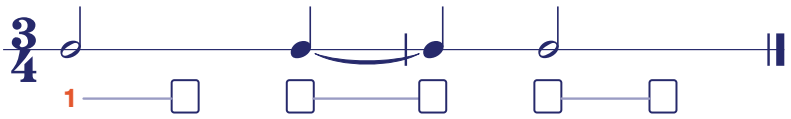
Off the beat

REMEMBER Hemiola: two bars of 3/4 felt as three big beats.

1 Hemiola

★★★

Count it in 3/4 in the boxes, then clap it feeling three minims across the two bars.



2 Clap and count

★★☆

Clap the syncopations with a metronome, counting aloud. Tick a circle each day it is steady.



3 In your music

★☆☆

Find each of these in a piece you are learning or listening to.

FIND IN A PIECE YOU ARE LEARNING	PIECE	BAR
a syncopation		
Swing written at the top		

4 Swing it

★★☆

Play a C major scale in swing quavers (“doo-ba, doo-ba”), then straight. Tick a circle each day.

5 Listen for it

★☆☆

Listen to each one and tick it when you hear what is listed.

Joplin, The Entertainer	syncopation	○
Miller, In the Mood	swing	○
Bernstein, America	hemiola	○

Date _____

TIME · REVIEW

Review

TEN MINUTES No help, no piano. Mark it with the answers on page 17: one mark for each answer.

1 Name the notes ★☆☆

Write the name of each note.



2 How many beats? ★☆☆

Crotchet = 1 beat.





3 Time signatures ★★☆

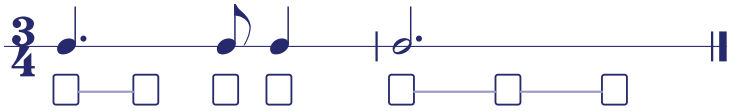
Write a time signature for each bar, then circle the compound ones.



time signature _____ time signature _____ time signature _____

4 Count it ★★☆

Write a count in every box.



5 True or false? ★★☆

Circle T or F.

A tie joins two notes of different pitches.	T	F
6/8 has two beats in a bar.	T	F
In 4/4, a beam may cross the middle of the bar.	T	F

Score ____ **/ 18**

Date _____

TIME · PROGRESS

My progress

HOW TO USE Tick each column when it is true. Come back to this page every few weeks.

CONCEPT	I KNOW IT	I CAN WRITE IT	I CAN PLAY IT	HANDBOOK
pulse, tempo and strong beats	☐	☐	☐	p. 34
bar lines and repeat signs	☐	☐	☐	p. 34
note and rest values	☐	☐	☐	p. 36
dots and ties	☐	☐	☐	p. 39
simple time signatures	☐	☐	☐	p. 41
compound time (6/8)	☐	☐	☐	p. 43
irregular time (5/4, 7/8)	☐	☐	☐	p. 43
grouping with beams	☐	☐	☐	p. 45
triplets and semiquavers	☐	☐	☐	p. 45
upbeats	☐	☐	☐	p. 45
syncopation	☐	☐	☐	p. 47
swing	☐	☐	☐	p. 47
hemiola	☐	☐	☐	p. 47

Teacher's note

Date _____

TIME · ANSWERS

Answers

PAGE	ANSWERS
p. 1	Slow to fast: 4, 1, 3, 2 (60 slowest, 120 fastest). Strong beats on 1; in 4/4 medium on 3. Signs: bar line, double bar line, final bar line, repeat signs. Count: 1 2 3 · 1–2 3 · 1–2–3. How fast does it feel: any answer; slower to faster is usual.
p. 2	Bar lines: 2/4 after notes 2, 3, 5, 7 and 8, final bar line after note 11; 3/4 after notes 2, 5 and 6, final bar line after note 8. Mistake: bar 3 has 4 beats.
p. 3	Draw it: minim, quaver, dotted minim, semibreve. Table: crotchet 1, crotchet rest; minim 2, minim rest; quaver ½, quaver rest; dotted minim 3, dotted minim rest; semiquaver ¼, semiquaver rest. Why a whole note: minim = half note, 2 beats; crotchet = quarter note, 1 beat; quaver = eighth note, ½ beat; semiquaver = sixteenth note, ¼ beat.
p. 4	Stems: up on the right below the middle line, down on the left above it, either on it. Finish with a rest: minim, crotchet, minim, crotchet. Empty slices: minim rest 2 beats (2 pizzas), crotchet rest 1 beat (1 pizza), quaver rest ½ beat (half a pizza).
p. 5	Sums: 3, 1½, 4, 6, 2, 2. Complete: crotchet, crotchet, crotchet, quaver, quaver, quaver. Ode to Joy: 1 2 3 4 · 1–2 & 3–4.
p. 6	Tie or dot: dotted minim, dotted crotchet, dotted semibreve. Mistake: bar 2 has 5 beats.
p. 7	Time signatures: 3/4, 2/4, 6/8 (3/4 also fits), 4/4, 5/4, 9/8. Compound: 6/8, 9/8, 12/8, 6/4 (beats 2, 3, 4, 2). Simple: 3/4 (3), 2/2 (2), 4/4 (4), 3/8 (3). 3/4: 3 crotchet beats; 6/8: 2 dotted-crotchet beats; C = 4/4, ¢ = 2/2.
p. 8	Bar lines: 3/4 after notes 3, 5 and 6, final bar line after note 9; 4/4 after notes 3 and 7, final bar line after note 8. Beams: 3/4 in three pairs; 6/8 in two groups of three. Seats: 3/4 carriage 1 a crotchet, carriage 2 a minim, carriage 3 a minim (or a minim rest); 4/4 carriage 1 a minim (or a minim rest), carriage 2 a minim (or a minim rest).
p. 9	6/8: 1 2 3 4 5 6 · 1 4. Beams: 3/4 (pairs), 6/8 (threes). 5/4: 1 2 3 1 2. 7/8: 1 2 1 2 1 2 3. Compound beats: 6/8 2, 9/8 3, 12/8 4.
p. 10	Bar lines: 9/8 after the 3rd and 8th notes; 5/4 after the 4th and 9th notes. 3 + 3 + 2: 1 2 3 1 2 3 1 2.
p. 11	Grouping: ✓ × ✓ ×. Pizza: a triplet, a third of a beat each, 1 & a; four semiquavers, a quarter each, 1 e & a. Triplet: 1 & a 2. Semiquavers: 1 e & a 2 · 1 e & a 2.
p. 12	Upbeat: 3 · 1 2 3 · 1–2; the last bar needs 2 beats.
p. 13	Off the beat: bar 1 notes 3 and 4; bar 2 note 2; bar 3 notes 2 and 3. Syncopation: 1 & & 1 2. Swing is played as B. True or false: T, F, F.
p. 14	Hemiola: 1–2 3 · 1 2–3; felt as three minims.
p. 15	minim, quaver, dotted crotchet, semibreve · 4, 4 · 6/8 (3/4 also fits), 5/4, 9/8 (compound: 6/8 and 9/8) · 1–2 & 3 · 1–2–3 · F, T, F.

Pages with “make your own”, “in your music” and clapping have no single answer: check them at the piano with your teacher, or with the online lessons.

Date _____